

Structural Foundations of Health (Part 2)

January 28, 2026

Today

- Policy & health
- Labor conditions
- Community vs. population assessments
- **Group exercise** (20 min)

7. Policy & Health

7. Policy Examples

Policies that promote health:

- EITC (income support)
- Medicaid expansion
- Paid leave

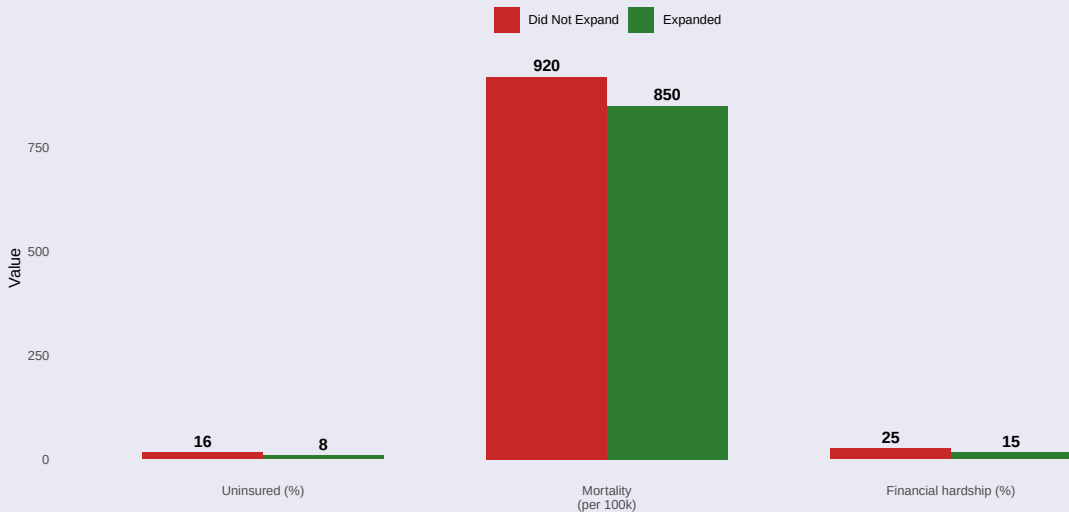
Policy decisions have measurable health consequences

Policies that harm health:

- Mass incarceration
- Restrictive zoning

7. Medicaid Expansion Impact

Medicaid Expansion Impact (2014–2020)



Sources: Sommers et al. (2017), Miller & Wherry (2019)

8. Labor Conditions

8. Work Affects Health

Physical hazards:

- Chemical exposures
- Repetitive strain



- Injury risk

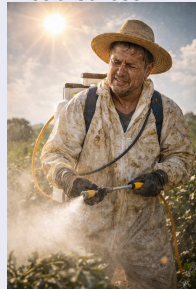
Psychosocial hazards:

- High demand + low control
- Effort-reward imbalance
- Job insecurity



Environmental exposures:

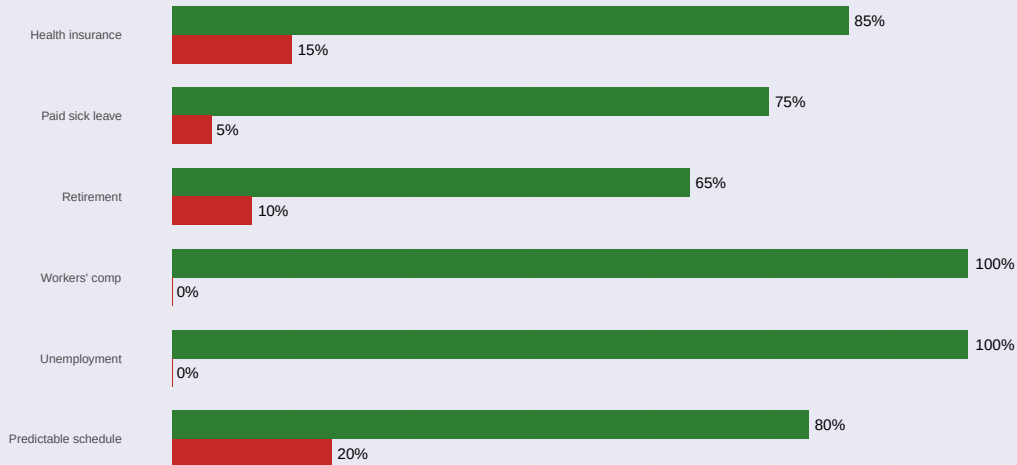
- Pesticides
- Toxic chemicals
- Heat stress



8. Gig Economy

Traditional vs. Gig Economy Benefits

■ Gig/Contract ■ Traditional



9. Community vs. Population Assessments

9. Two Approaches

Community Assessment

- Specific neighborhood
- Involves residents
- Assets + needs
- Action plan

Example: South Side Chicago food deserts
Both answer different questions

Population Assessment

- Larger area
- Administrative data
- Disease patterns
- Surveillance

Example: CDC state diabetes rates

Group Exercise

Community Analysis (20 min)

Your task:

- 1 Analyze your community scenario
- 2 Identify top 3 structural determinants
- 3 Recommend 1 intervention
- 4 Present in 2 minutes

Community Analysis (20 min)

Groups:

- **Group Gupta:** Rural coal town
- **Group Wakefield:** Urban food desert
- **Group Pasteur:** Immigrant community
- **Group Nightingale:** Native reservation
- **Group Fauci:** Gentrifying neighborhood

Analysis Framework

Consider:

- **Social:** Capital, discrimination
- **Economic:** Income, jobs
- **Environmental:** Built environment, hazards
- **Policy:** Housing, labor, healthcare

Be specific! Use scenario details

Next Class

Monday: Quiz + Measuring population health

Thank you!

Now: Break into groups